

词汇: *nature* 自然

- 1 Many young Brits are buying **binoculars** in hopes of encountering one of nature's most physically and **audibly** beautiful creatures – birds. You might think of birdwatching as an old-fashioned **pastime** most often enjoyed by the generations before you, but surveys conducted by the RSPB show a 47% increase in participation overall, with an even higher 1,088% **surge** by Gen Zers. So, why do so many young people want to **flock** to the park to watch birds?
- 2 A group leader at RSPB Bristol highlighted how many students have joined his **outings**. He mentioned that some who join have 'never been out in their local nature spaces' and 'want to explore'. He added that the **diversity** of species you can find is impressive 'considering it's so urban' around the city. There is also the rise of a desire to disconnect from technology and go outside, or as Gen Z would call it **touch grass**, to help with mental health. Research from the University of Surrey has looked at how bird sounds restore attention and even **alleviate** stress.
- 3 **Ironically**, when interviewed by BBC Bristol, individuals mentioned how phones and social media have actually helped encourage the **hype** of this hobby. There are now a variety of apps in which you can record a birdsong and have it instantly identified. People also use social media to share knowledge and location for birds. A phenomenon known as '**bioblitzing**', a combination of bio and blitzing, has emerged. This is when a walker documents as many birds and other species of animals as they can within a limited amount of time. It has been said to create a safe space in which birdwatchers can get into friendly competitions over who can **spot** the most! Furthermore, a **buzz** around the birdwatching hashtag has **cultivated** humour around turning 30 and entering your 'birdwatching era'.
- 4 Whether it's the chance to reconnect with nature, improve mental wellbeing, or join a growing online community, birdwatching is no longer seen as a hobby **reserved** for older generations. Young people are **embracing** it in record numbers, using both technology and the outdoors to discover the wildlife on their **doorstep**. From identifying birdsongs with apps to competing in bioblitzing challenges, a modern **twist** has transformed the pastime into something fresh and accessible. It seems that for Gen Z and young millennials alike, birdwatching has become a **hoot**.

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

- a. More young people are enjoying birdwatching.
- b. Most young people have always enjoyed birdwatching.
- c. Young people might be enjoying birdwatching.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. According to RSPB surveys, what was the increase in birdwatching participation among Gen Z?
 - a. 47%
 - b. 108%
 - c. 1,088%
2. Why do some students join RSPB outings, according to the group leader in Bristol?
 - a. to complete school assignments
 - b. to explore local natural spaces they have never visited
 - c. to learn photography
3. Research from the University of Surrey found that bird sounds can help reduce stress.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
4. Which of the following is an example of "bioblitzing"?
 - a. building birdhouses in local parks
 - b. documenting as many species as possible within an hour
 - c. feeding birds in urban areas
5. Most young birdwatchers do not use social media to share information about the birds they have found.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Birdwatching has now become a real **1)** _____ for young adults. A huge **2)** _____ of young people going on birdwatching **3)** _____ has been observed. Their wish is to **4)** _____ these **5)** _____ beautiful creatures and their relaxing birdsongs.

audibly	encounter	flock
hoot		ironically
outings		surge

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

binoculars	双筒望远镜
audibly	可以听到地
pastime	消遣，娱乐
surge	猛增，激增
flock	蜂拥而至，成群前往
outing	外出活动
diversity	多样性
touch grass	出门走走，亲近大自然
alleviate	缓解，减轻
ironically	具有讽刺意味地
hype	大肆宣传，炒作
bioblitzing	生物速查活动
spot	发现，看到
buzz	热议，热潮
cultivate	促成，催生出
era	时，时期
reserve	只属于...的
embrace	欣然接受
doorstep	家门口，近在咫尺的地方
twist	意外的变化
a hoot	非常有趣的事

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

a. More young people are enjoying birdwatching.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **c. ... surveys conducted by the RSPB show a 47% increase in participation overall, with an even higher 1,088% surge by Gen Zers.**
2. **b. He mentioned that *some who join have 'never been out in their local nature spaces' and 'want to explore'.***
3. **a. True. Research from the University of Surrey has looked at how *bird sounds* restore attention and even *alleviate stress*.**
4. **b. This is when a walker *documents as many birds and other species of animals as they can within a limited amount of time*.**
5. **b. False. *People also use social media to share knowledge and location for birds.***

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Birdwatching has now become a real **hoot** for young adults. A huge **surge** of young people going on birdwatching **outings** has been observed. Their wish is to **encounter** these **audibly** beautiful creatures and their relaxing birdsongs.